

Dark-Component Residual Response Audit: A Claim-Bounded Diagnostic Map of SPARC Galaxy Rotation-Curve Residual Regimes

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May 2026

Repository DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.20233908

GitHub repository: <https://github.com/yokken0907/dark-component-residual-response-audit>

Abstract

This paper presents the Dark-Component Residual Response Audit (DCRRA), a claim-bounded diagnostic audit of dark-component-like residuals in SPARC galaxy rotation-curve data [2]. The study does not attempt to identify a dark-matter particle, exclude dark matter, replace Λ CDM, falsify MOND/RAR [4, 3], falsify NFW halos [5], explain the Bullet Cluster, or solve the Hubble tension. Instead, it asks a narrower diagnostic question: whether galaxy-scale residuals that are often interpreted as dark-component-like can be decomposed into multiple residual regimes using the previously developed SN-RRF parent result [6], NFW-like [5] and RAR-like [3] comparators, nuisance/pathology pass-through classes, proxy association audits, and destructive/constructive null controls.

Across 143 eligible SPARC galaxies, DCRRA constructs a seven-zone residual-regime map. The final map contains 54 response-family-dominant galaxies, 23 response-family with NFW-competitive galaxies, 6 halo-comparator-dominant galaxies, 16 mixed three-way competitive galaxies, 30 nuisance-sensitive galaxies, 12 pathology/archive galaxies, and 2 unresolved triangular cases. The response-family-associated zones contain 77 galaxies, while pathology or nuisance pass-through classes contain 42 galaxies. DCRRA6 null controls reject destructive shuffled-label/proxy nulls in 4/4 tests and obtain nontrivial proxy-only reconstruction signals, with accuracy 0.314685 and balanced accuracy 0.328735. DCRRA8 locks the synthesis with 9/9 guards passed.

The safe conclusion is that dark-component-like SPARC rotation-curve residuals are not monolithic under this diagnostic protocol. They can be represented as a residual-regime map containing response-family-like, halo-comparator-like, mixed, nuisance-sensitive, pathology/archive, and unresolved zones. This is a diagnostic taxonomy, not a causal physical classification and not a dark-matter replacement claim.

1 Scope and claim boundary

DCRRA is built as a diagnostic taxonomy/audit of galaxy-scale residuals in the SPARC rotation-curve context [2]. Its central purpose is to separate residual regimes, not to infer the physical identity or non-existence of dark matter. The following claims are explicitly outside the scope of this manuscript:

- dark-matter exclusion;
- Λ CDM replacement;

- MOND/RAR falsification;
- NFW-halo falsification;
- Bullet-Cluster explanation;
- dark-matter particle identity;
- Hubble-tension solution;
- SN-RRF as a physical substitute for dark matter.

The allowed claim is narrower: dark-component-like SPARC rotation-curve residuals can be audited as multiple diagnostic residual regimes rather than as a single homogeneous category.

2 Parent result and diagnostic motivation

The parent result is the Scale-Normalized Residual Response Family (SN-RRF), developed from earlier A10/TVC-RRF fixed-kernel diagnostics [6]. In the parent audit, the fixed exponent $n = 3.258993$ was not retained as a unique universal law. Instead, the residual response was reformulated as a scale-normalized monotone-saturating family. The DCRRA project imports this parent result only as a diagnostic residual-response framework. It does not import it as a dark-matter substitute, physical TVC mechanism, unique fixed-exponent law, or cosmological replacement model.

For a dimensionless radius $s = r/R_{\text{last}}$, a representative saturating kernel can be written as

$$K_n(x) = \frac{x^n}{1 + x^n}, \quad x = \frac{s}{s_c}, \quad (1)$$

where $s_c = r_c/R_{\text{last}}$ is a scale-normalized response radius and n is a response-shape parameter. DCRRA uses such quantities as diagnostic descriptors, not as microscopic physical laws.

3 Pipeline summary

The DCRRA pipeline proceeded through the following claim-bounded stages.

1. DCRRA0 locked the diagnostic-only scope and claim boundary.
2. DCRRA1 imported the SN-RRF parent result only as a diagnostic parent result.
3. DCRRA2 created a preliminary dark-component residual taxonomy.
4. DCRRA3 reclassified the SPARC population and audited stability relative to DCRRA2.
5. DCRRA4 performed a triangular NFW/RAR/SN-RRF comparator audit.
6. DCRRA5 tested environment/morphology/fit-proxy associations.
7. DCRRA6 performed destructive and constructive null controls.
8. DCRRA7 converted the preceding results into a residual-regime map.
9. DCRRA8 locked the claim-bounded synthesis and authorized the manuscript/repository package.

No stage converts the residual map into a physical dark-matter taxonomy.

4 Triangular comparator and proxy audits

DCRRA4 compared NFW-like [5], RAR-like [3], and SN-RRF-family-like [6] diagnostic interpretations without treating the comparison as a cosmological model-selection claim. The audit separated the population into response-family, NFW-related, RAR-related/competitive, mixed, nuisance-sensitive, pathology/archive, and unresolved regimes.

DCRRA5 then tested whether the triangular residual-regime labels showed systematic association with proxy variables. Eight proxy binnings succeeded. Six proxies reached permutation $p \leq 0.05$, and all eight reached Cramer’s $V \geq 0.25$. The strongest proxy association was the number of rotation-curve points. Significant associations also appeared for outer baryon-fraction proxy, gas-fraction proxy, best n , response radius r_c/R_{last} , and response amplitude A/v_{outer}^2 . These are diagnostic associations only; they are not causal physical classifications.

5 Destructive and constructive null controls

DCRRA6 tested whether the DCRRA4 triangular classes were merely arbitrary labels. Destructive shuffled-label and shuffled-proxy nulls were rejected in 4/4 tests at $p \leq 0.05$. A proxy-only nearest-centroid constructive control recovered nontrivial class information, with accuracy 0.314685 and balanced accuracy 0.328735. Passing these controls supports proxy-coherent diagnostic structure, but it does not identify physical dark-matter categories.

6 Residual-regime map

DCRRA7 produced the final residual-regime map. The map contains seven zones and passes 8/8 guards. DCRRA8 then locks the synthesis with 9/9 guards passed. The zone counts are shown in Table 1 and Figure 1.

Table 1: DCRRA residual-map zone counts for the 143-galaxy population.

Residual-map zone	Count	Fraction
RESPONSE_FAMILY_DOMINANT_ZONE	54	37.76%
NUISANCE_SENSITIVE_ZONE	30	20.98%
RESPONSE_FAMILY_WITH_NFW_COMPETITIVE_ZONE	23	16.08%
MIXED_THREE_WAY_COMPETITIVE_ZONE	16	11.19%
PATHOLOGY_ARCHIVE_ZONE	12	8.39%
HALO_COMPARATOR_DOMINANT_ZONE	6	4.20%
UNRESOLVED_TRIANGULAR_ZONE	2	1.40%

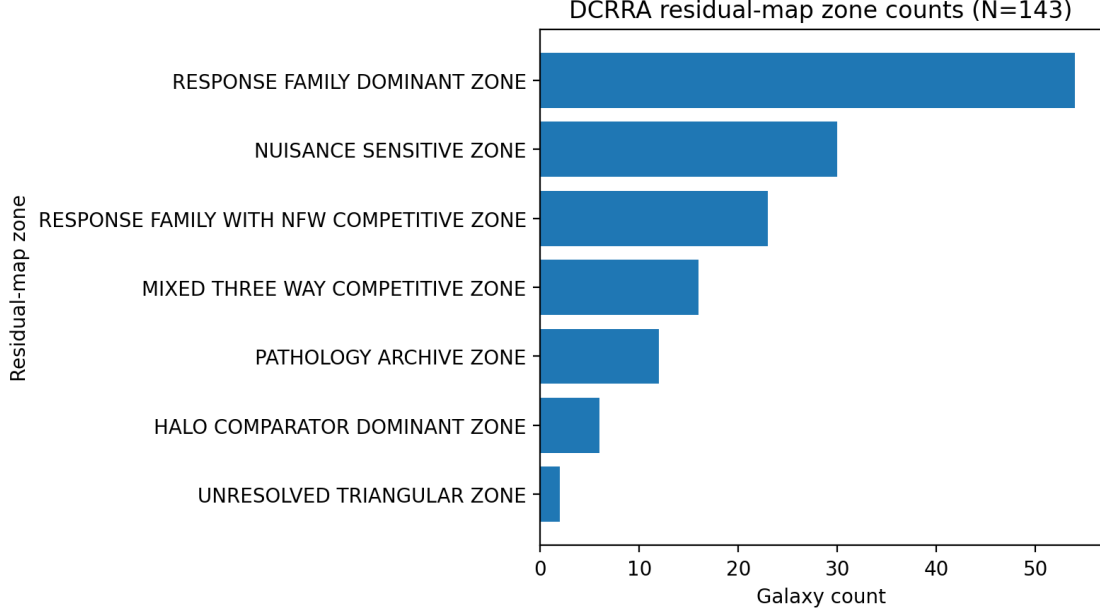


Figure 1: Residual-map zone counts. The largest zone remains below a single-zone monopoly threshold, preserving a multi-regime interpretation.

7 Zone-level medians

Table 2 summarizes key medians by zone. The response-family-dominant zone has median best $n = 2.25$, median $r_c/R_{\text{last}} = 0.3335$, median $A/v_{\text{outer}}^2 = 0.7805$, and strongly negative median diagnostic margins against both NFW-like and RAR-like comparators. The halo-comparator-dominant zone is small, with 6 galaxies, and has positive median family-minus-NFW margin, preserving an NFW-related diagnostic regime. Pathology/archive cases retain extreme or boundary-like descriptors and are not promoted into physical categories.

Table 2: Selected residual-map zone medians. Negative ΔAIC values indicate lower AIC [1] for the SN-RRF-family diagnostic comparator relative to the named comparator.

Zone	Count	best n	r_c/R_{last}	A/v_{outer}^2	$\Delta\text{AIC fam-NFW}$	$\Delta\text{AIC fam-RAR}$
Halo comp. dom.	6	3	0.365	0.675	18.18	-78.12
Mixed 3-way	16	2.5	0.365	0.724	-2.49	-2.41
Nuisance sens.	30	1.62	0.275	0.759	-10.47	-42.03
Pathology/archive	12	12	0.943	2.198	-8.25	-108.07
Response dom.	54	2.25	0.334	0.780	-38.42	-78.46
Response + NFW comp.	23	2.5	0.189	0.679	-3.61	-27.48
Unresolved	2	3.25	0.521	0.799	-17.31	-6.25

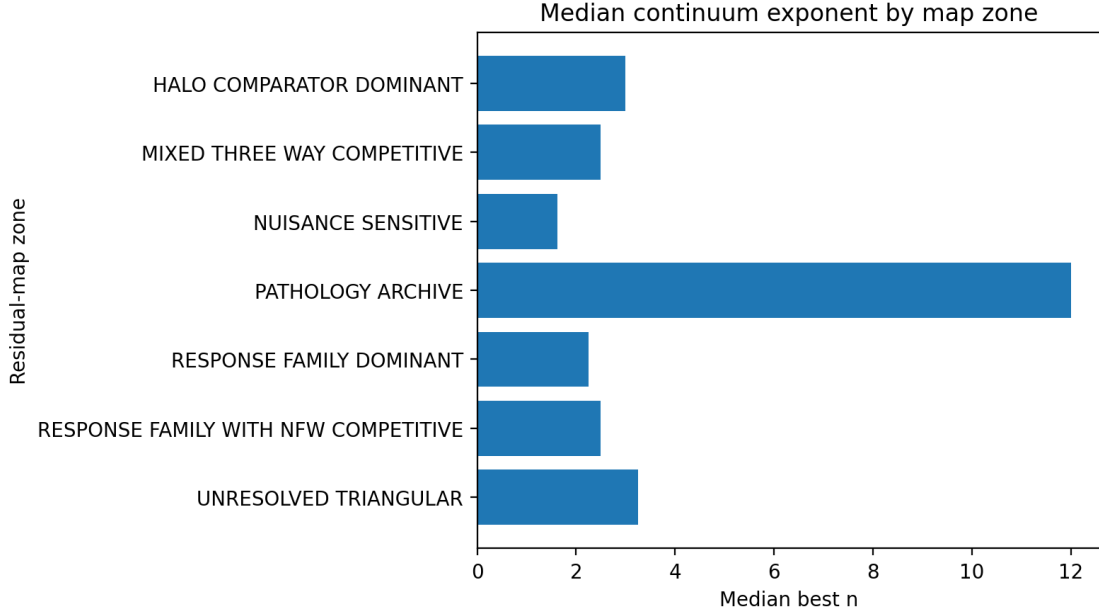


Figure 2: Median continuum exponent by residual-map zone. The spread reinforces the family-level interpretation rather than a universal fixed exponent.

8 Synthesis

The central DCRRA result is a residual-regime map rather than a physical dark-matter taxonomy. The tested SPARC residual population is not monolithic. It separates into response-family-like, halo-comparator-like, mixed, nuisance-sensitive, pathology/archive, and unresolved regimes under the DCRRA protocol.

The most compact safe manuscript-level claim is:

Dark-component-like galaxy rotation-curve residuals can be audited as multiple diagnostic residual regimes rather than as a single homogeneous category. In the tested SPARC population, a response-family-associated zone is prominent, but NFW-comparator, mixed, nuisance-sensitive, pathology/archive, and unresolved regimes remain explicitly preserved.

This language is intentionally weaker than a discovery claim about the nature of dark matter and stronger than a purely descriptive table: it says that a structured, null-controlled diagnostic decomposition exists under the tested protocol.

9 Limitations

Several limitations are essential. First, the map is based on SPARC rotation-curve residuals and does not include direct lensing constraints, galaxy clusters, CMB structure formation, or direct-detection experiments. Second, the NFW-like and RAR-like components are comparators in a diagnostic audit, not exhaustive representatives of their full theoretical model classes. Third, proxy associations are not causal explanations. Fourth, nuisance-sensitive and pathology/archive zones are preserved rather than repaired or reinterpreted. Finally, the pipeline does not determine whether dark matter exists, what its particle identity is, or whether modified gravity or baryonic feedback provides a better physical explanation.

10 Conclusion

DCRRA0-DCRRA8 support a claim-bounded diagnostic map of dark-component-like SPARC galaxy rotation-curve residuals. In 143 eligible galaxies, the final seven-zone map contains 77 response-family-associated cases, 6 halo-comparator-dominant cases, 16 mixed cases, 42 pathology/nuisance pass-through cases, and 2 unresolved cases. The maximum single-zone fraction is 0.377622, avoiding collapse into a single homogeneous category. DCRRA6 null controls support proxy-coherent structure, and DCRRA8 locks the synthesis with 9/9 guards passed.

The result should be used as a diagnostic residual-regime map. It should not be described as dark-matter exclusion, Λ CDM replacement, MOND/RAR falsification, NFW falsification, Bullet-Cluster explanation, particle-identification inference, Hubble-tension solution, or a physical dark-matter substitute.

Repository and archival DOI

The repository package associated with this manuscript is archived on Zenodo. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.20233908. GitHub repository: <https://github.com/yokken0907/dark-component-residual-response-audit>. This archival reference is provided for reproducibility, provenance, and citation of the public release package [7]; it does not broaden the claim boundary beyond the diagnostic residual-regime map stated in the main text.

Acknowledgments

Large language models, including OpenAI ChatGPT, were used as research-assistance tools for theory structuring, verification-protocol organization, code drafting, numerical-audit workflow design, and manuscript editing support. The author remains responsible for the final scientific claims, claim boundaries, interpretation, and manuscript content.

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